

2. INFRASTRUCTURE

TERMINAL SIZE HAS TO GO UP THREE-FOLD

Size (in mn sq. ft)

DELHI T3	DUBAI T3
5.4	18.4

Changi (4 terminals): **13.6**

3. PASSENGER TRAFFIC

TREBLE THE HANDLING CAPACITY

International passengers per month in 2024 (in mn)

DELHI T3	DUBAI T3
1.6	5.3

Changi: **3.8**



4. BAGGAGE HANDLING

INSTAL FULLY AUTOMATED EARLY BAGGAGE STORAGE (EBS*) SYSTEM

DELHI T1 & T3: 12,800 bags per hr capacity, 24 baggage belts

DUBAI T3: 15,000 bags per hr, 90 km of conveyor belts, 4,500 EBS** positions

CHANGI: Fully automated EBS facility; 13-km long Inter-Terminal Transfer Baggage System

** EBS allows passengers to automatically check in their baggage early and retrieve them*

5. ANCHOR CARRIERS

AIR INDIA AND INDIGO NEED BIGGER AND MORE LONG DISTANCE AIRCRAFT

DELHI T1 & T3

Air India and IndiGo

- AI: 205-strong fleet, 6 A350s, 21 Boeing 777s, 29 787s
- IndiGo: 434-strong fleet, 2 Boeing 777s, 12 737s

DUBAI

- Emirates: 261-strong fleet, almost all A380 and Boeing 777s

CHANGI

- Singapore Airlines: 161 mostly wide-bodied aircraft, 62 A350s, 8 A380s, 27 Boeing 777s, 23 787s

6. LEISURE ECOSYSTEM

HUBS REQUIRE MASSIVE DUTY-FREE SHOPPING AND FOOD ARCADES

DELHI T3

- 215,000 sq. ft retail space, over 200 stores
- Annual revenue: **Rs 248 cr.**

DUBAI T3

- 430,000 sq. ft, Dubai Duty Free is 60,000 sq. ft, foodcourt 22,000 sq. ft
- Annual revenue: **Rs 17,200 cr.**

CHANGI

- 750,000 sq. ft, indoor Shiseido Forest Valley alone is 240,000 sq. ft
- Annual revenue: **Rs 11,180 cr.**



Graphic by **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY**

sitions. It also has 90 km of conveyor belts capable of handling 15,000 bags per hour at a speed of 27 km per hour.

Changi, on the other hand, has specifically added an EBS facility covering a floor area as large as four Olympic-sized swimming pools. The fully automated system, with 1.2 km of conveyor belts, processes 2,400 bags at any given time. Automated cranes place bags in slots, and when it is time to start loading a flight, say, around three hours before departure, the cranes retrieve that flight's bags and send them to the departure baggage track. It has a subterranean Inter-Terminal Transfer Baggage System (ITTBS) of more than 13 km, connecting Terminals 1, 2 and 3, capable of handling over 2,700 bags an hour, moving bags at seven metres per second.

In Delhi, DIAL plans to develop its own EBS, says CEO Jaipuriar. IGI's T3 currently has a baggage processing capacity of 12,800 bags per hour. It has 14 baggage belts in T3 and 10 in T1. But it's ultimately storing large volumes of baggage for long periods. Hundreds of baggage items checked into the various feeder flights need to be transferred to the transit flight, all of which arrive at different times. "The airport also needs to increase EBS capacity for connecting bags. We have got all infra-related requirements evaluated and will plug the gaps from our side," Jaipuriar adds.

NOT JUST AN AIRPORT

Successful international hubs are an ecosystem of luxury, business activities, shopping, entertainment and tourism. This can't be said about any airport in India yet. The Dubai Duty Free, for instance, is a 60,000-odd sq. ft shopping complex that earns an annual revenue of close to $2 billion (Rs 17,200 crore).

Singapore's Changi has positioned itself as an attractive destination for corporate, social and leisure events. Changi Jewel, a multi-dimensional tourist destination, is a mall of sorts, with outdoor and indoor venues. Connected to the arrival hall of Terminal 1, it offers attractions like a lush green sanctuary, a 40-metre-tall